

Account-Based Selling Offering Toolkit

UPDATED: NOVEMBER 2025

B2B Transformation

WHAT IT IS

B2B sales transformation involves new processes, technology, data, and insights to allow sales teams to engage business customers more efficiently and effectively. Key capabilities are Sales, Service, Commerce, and Analytics and Reporting.

B2B sales transformation engagements are typically preceded by B2B Transformation - Wedge Offerings that identify a North Star vision for the client to rally around.

Key Stakeholders: CRO/VP Sales, CDO/CTO/VP Commerce, CIO

KEY BUSINESS OUTCOMES

- Reduced cost to serve
- Increased customer acquisition
- Increased AOV
- Increased customer retention rates

See next pages for wedge and packaged engagement details for each module.

GTM HUB PAGE

This [link](#) has all the content to support the offering: training, engagement models, case studies, thought leadership, Merkle reports, etc.

SUB-OFFERING

Account-Based Selling

AI-led Service and Advisory

Marketplace Adoption and Acceleration

COMPLEMENTARY OFFERINGS

ABX

YOUR 3-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B Transformation: Wedges

WHAT IT IS

Enabling comprehensive organizational transformation through an Account-Based Everything mindset that reshapes how your business thinks, operates, and engages with customers.

We partner with leadership teams to fundamentally reshape business strategy, organizational structure, and cultural mindset—aligning every function around high-value account success. Our approach transforms how teams think, operate, and measure success by embedding account-centricity into the DNA of the organization.

These wedge offerings ”setup” the bigger account-based selling engagements and solutions.

KEY BUSINESS OUTCOMES

- Accelerated revenue growth through strategic alignment of critical business functions around target account success and expansion.
- Improved organizational agility from cross-functional teams unified by shared account objectives and customer outcomes.
- Enhanced competitive differentiation by delivering coordinated, best-in-class experiences that competitors cannot replicate.
- Sustained market leadership through a customer-first operating model that drives continuous innovation and long-term relationships.

WEDGE

Can be delivered at less than \$100k USD, to ‘open the door’.

North Star Digital Visioning	Agile Op Model Assessment	B2B Customer Experience Assessment	Tech and Data Modernization	Value Realization and Growth Optimization
\$250-500K USD	\$150-300K	\$250-750K	\$250-500K	\$150-500K

YOUR 3-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B Transformation: Account-Based Selling

WHAT IT IS

A comprehensive B2B sales transformation approach that orchestrates the entire customer journey from initial prospect identification through order fulfillment and ongoing relationship management.

Our Account-Based Selling solution integrates AI-driven lead qualification, intelligent sales automation, personalized customer experiences, and seamless order management to create a unified, data-driven sales ecosystem. This end-to-end approach transforms traditional sales processes into a strategic, account-centric revenue engine that delivers measurable business outcomes across the entire customer lifecycle.

KEY BUSINESS OUTCOMES

Accelerated Revenue Growth: Streamlined MQL to SQL conversion with AI-powered lead scoring and automated nurturing workflows that reduce sales cycle time by up to 40%.

Enhanced Customer Experience: Personalized self-service capabilities, intelligent product recommendations, and seamless quote-to-cash processes that increase customer satisfaction and retention.

Operational Excellence: Automated order orchestration, smart fulfillment routing, and integrated supply chain management that reduces operational costs while improving delivery performance.

Data-Driven Decision Making: Real-time analytics and forecasting capabilities that provide actionable insights for strategic account planning and resource optimization.

ENGAGEMENTS

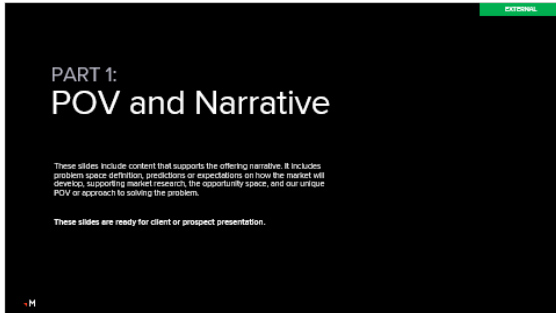
Are **over \$100k** USD that you can sell individually or together.

MQL to SQL	CPQ	Pricing Analytics	B2B Commerce	B2B Marketplace	Order Orchestration	Digital Shelf Analytics
\$200-\$1m+ USD	\$500-\$1m+	\$250-\$500k	\$250-\$1m+	\$500K-\$2m+ USD	\$200-\$1m+ USD	\$100-\$500K USD

WHAT'S INSIDE

PART 1: POV and Narrative

EXTERNAL



[LINK](#)

PART 2: Case Studies and Why Merkle

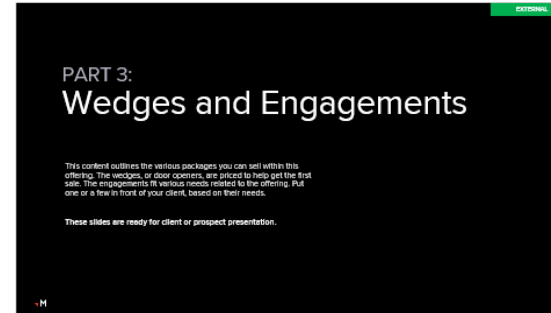
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[LINK](#)

PART 3: Wedges and Engagements

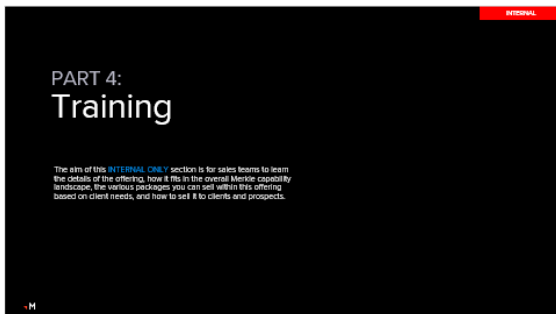
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[LINK](#)

PART 4: Training

INTERNAL



[LINK](#)



[LINK](#)



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[LINK](#)

PART 1: POV and Narrative

These slides include content that supports the offering narrative. It includes problem space definition, predictions or expectations on how the market will develop, supporting market research, the opportunity space, and our unique POV or approach to solving the problem.

These slides are ready for client or prospect presentation.

The most successful businesses have
always known **how to ride waves.**

A dramatic photograph of a massive ocean wave crashing, with white foam and deep blue water. The sky is dark and stormy, adding to the sense of power and scale. The wave is the central focus, with its crest breaking into a large, billowing cloud of white foam.

**But now, the waves are crashing
down on B2B customers.**

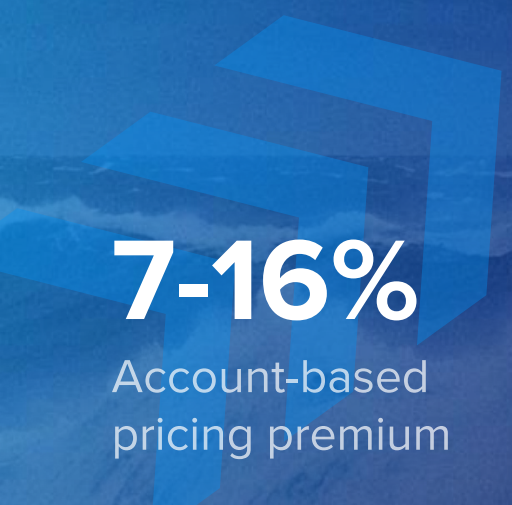


**Profitability
Pressure**

**AI
Uncertainty**

**Workforce
Fatigue**

**Geopolitical
Instability**



7-16%

Account-based
pricing premium

1.7x

Increase in B2B
account retention

54%

lower rate of burnout
among employees

52%

anticipate tariffs will
amplify economic
contraction

The stakes have never been higher.

B2B has never been
more competitive

+62%

increase in brands considered for the
average B2B purchase

Deal cycles have never
been **more complex**

+4.5

Increase in weeks of the average B2B
purchase lifecycle since 2022, to 379 days

And the job
has never
been harder.

B2B buyers don't feel
heard or well understood

71%

of B2B buyers say they want suppliers to
spend more time understanding and solving
their **day-to-day problems**

Buyers are more
frustrated than ever

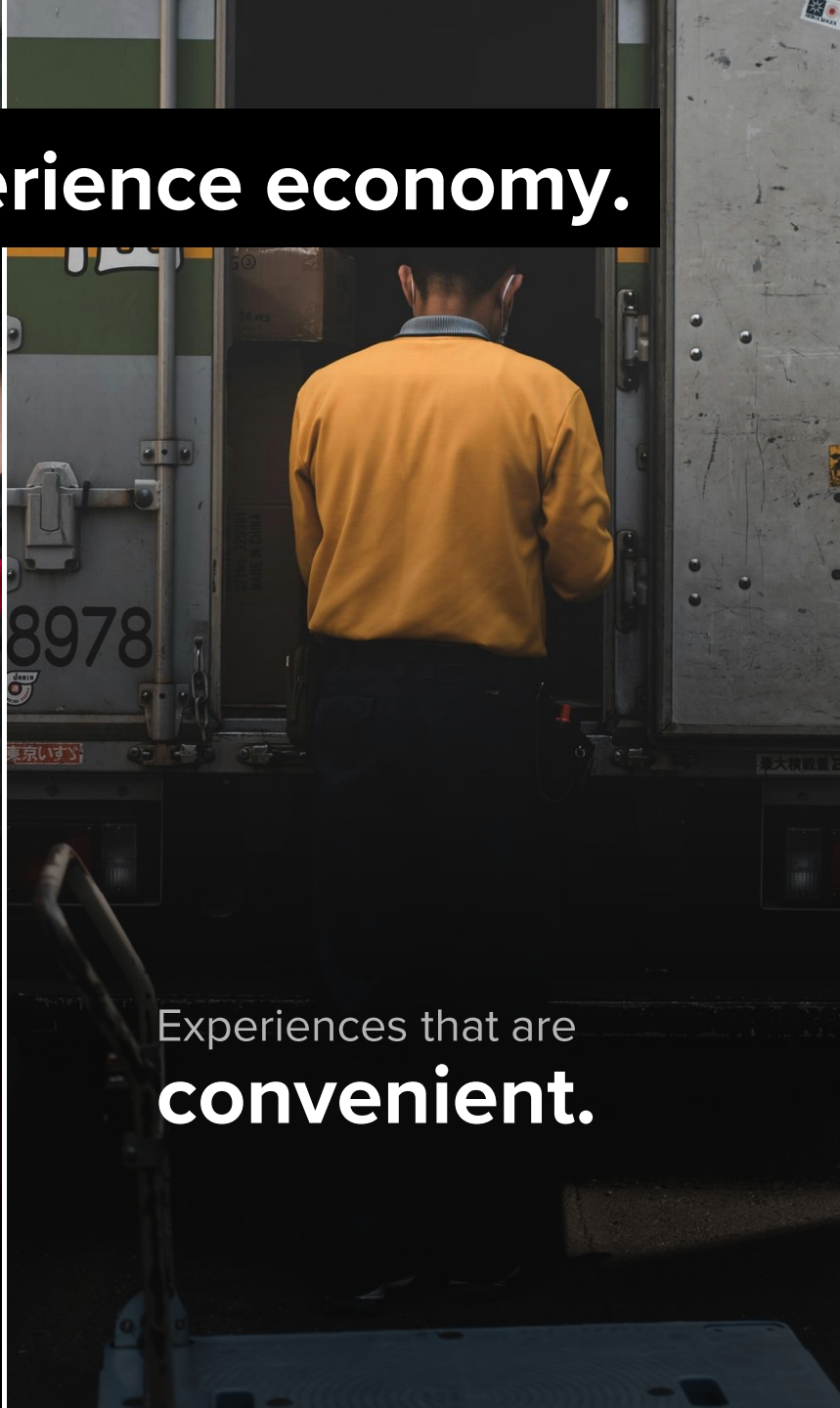
52%

of B2B buyers think it **takes far too long**
to make a purchase from their B2B suppliers

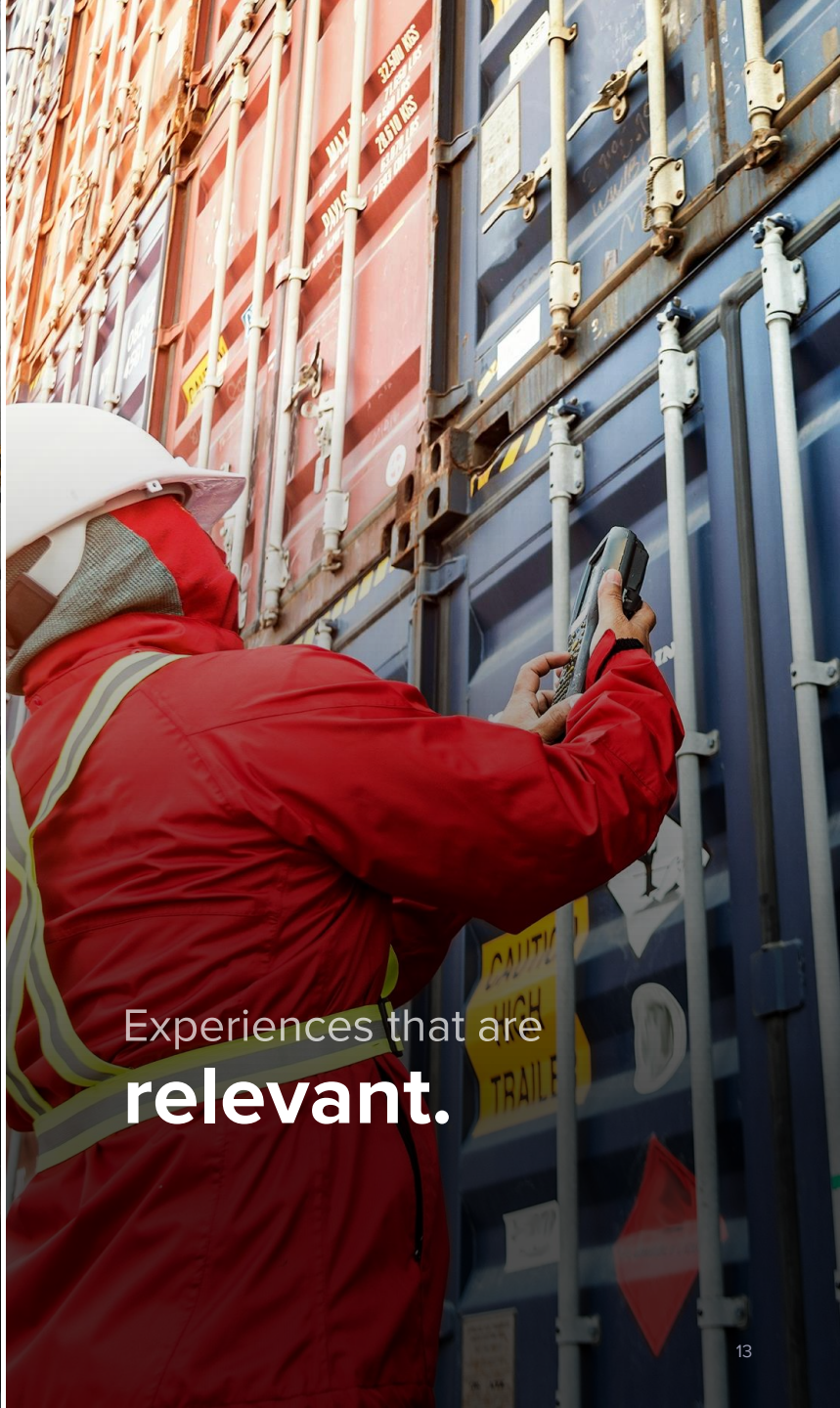


We power the experience economy.

Experiences that create
trust.



Experiences that are
convenient.



Experiences that are
relevant.

It's not how many times
you get it right.

It's how **few times**
you get it wrong.

Maximizing value across the entire B2B lifecycle requires a different approach.

“Do I feel safe signing a contract with them?”

“Are they active thought leaders?”

“Do they support us with expertise?”

“Do they offer enough variety and choice?”

“Are they there when I need them?”

“Do they offer tools to maximize value?”

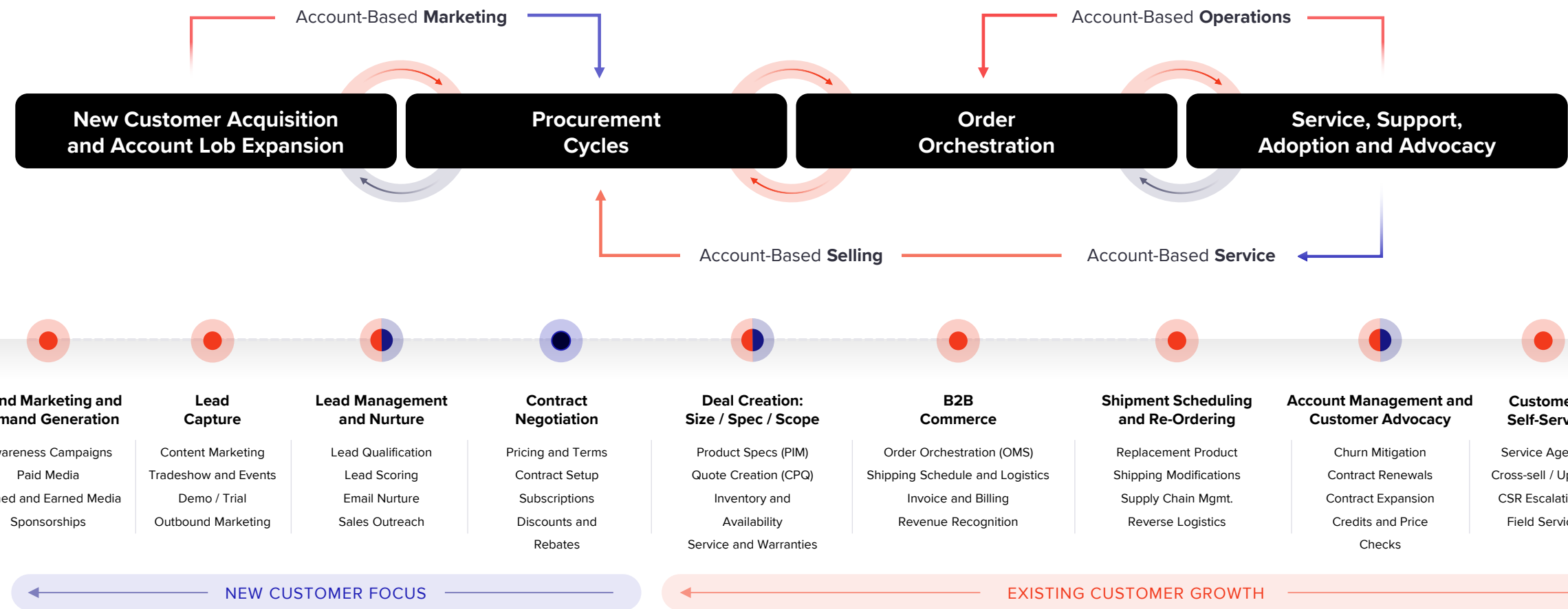
“Do they allow self-service customization?”

Account-based
everything.

Transforming your B2B Customer Experience.

The need to deliver dynamic **Account-Based Experiences** is being fueled by the **Modernization of Technologies** and the prolific **Rise of Artificial Intelligence**, creating a pivot point for many B2B industries.

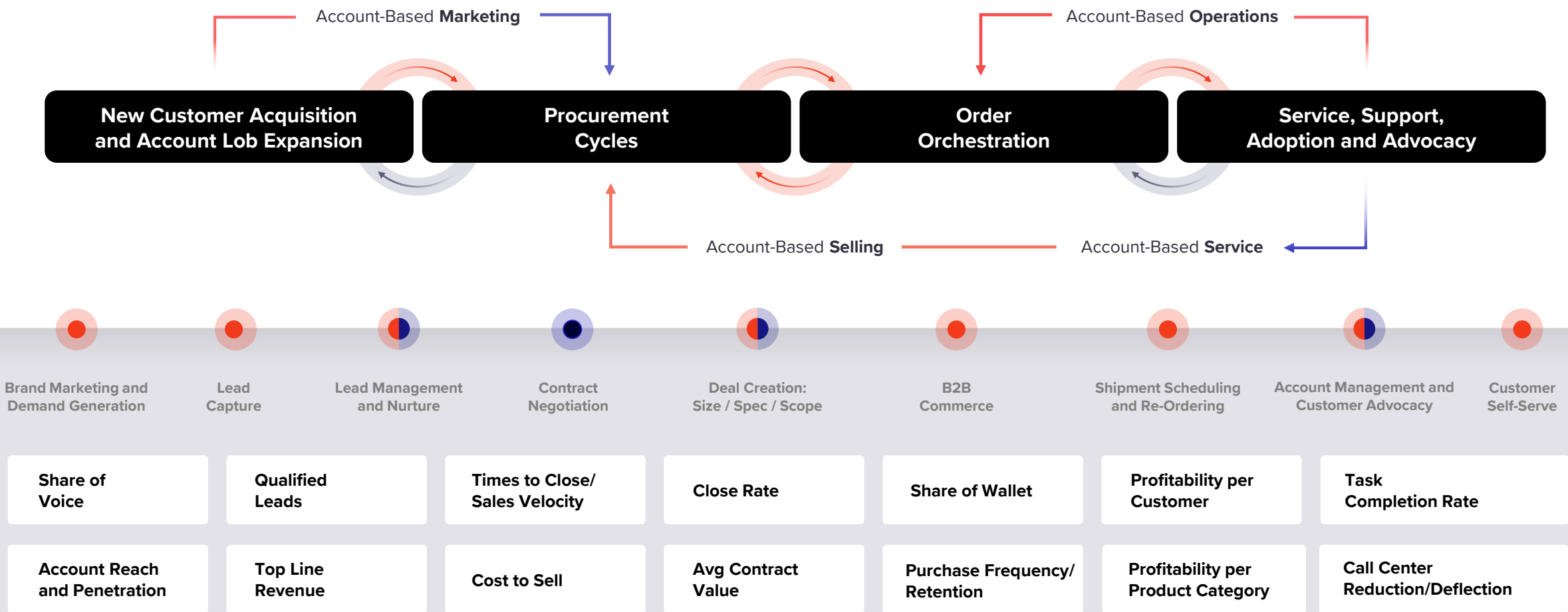
- Digital / AI Led
- Physical / Human Led



Driving Measurable Outcomes.

By leveraging **Account-Based Intelligence** to deliver leading **Account-Based Experiences**, B2B companies can more effectively drive **measurable outcomes** across these KPIs.

- Digital / AI Led
- Physical / Human Led



The impact of an “account-based everything” approach

■ Growth
■ Cost Out

Share of Voice

Receive **much higher NPS scores** (+83 vs +23)
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

Qualified Leads

25% increase in conversion of MQL to SQL
- Gartner

Times to Close/ Sales Velocity

Average sales cycles being **27% shorter**
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

Close Rate

38% higher sales win rate
- Salesforce

Share of Wallet

Almost **twice as likely to be adopted for further products and services** (41% vs 23%)
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

Profitability per Customer

20%+ higher ROI for “account-based” investments
- Forrester

Task Completion Rate

28% increase in engagement rates
- Gartner

Account Reach and Penetration

28% faster revenue growth
- Salesforce

Top Line Revenue

14% increase in pipeline conversion rate
- Gartner

Cost to Sell

20%+ higher ROI for “account-based” investments
- Forrester

Avg Contract Value

13% increase in average deal size
- Gartner

Purchase Frequency/ Retention

Nearly 3 times as likely to see increased spend from their customers in the future (33% vs. 13% for other brands)
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

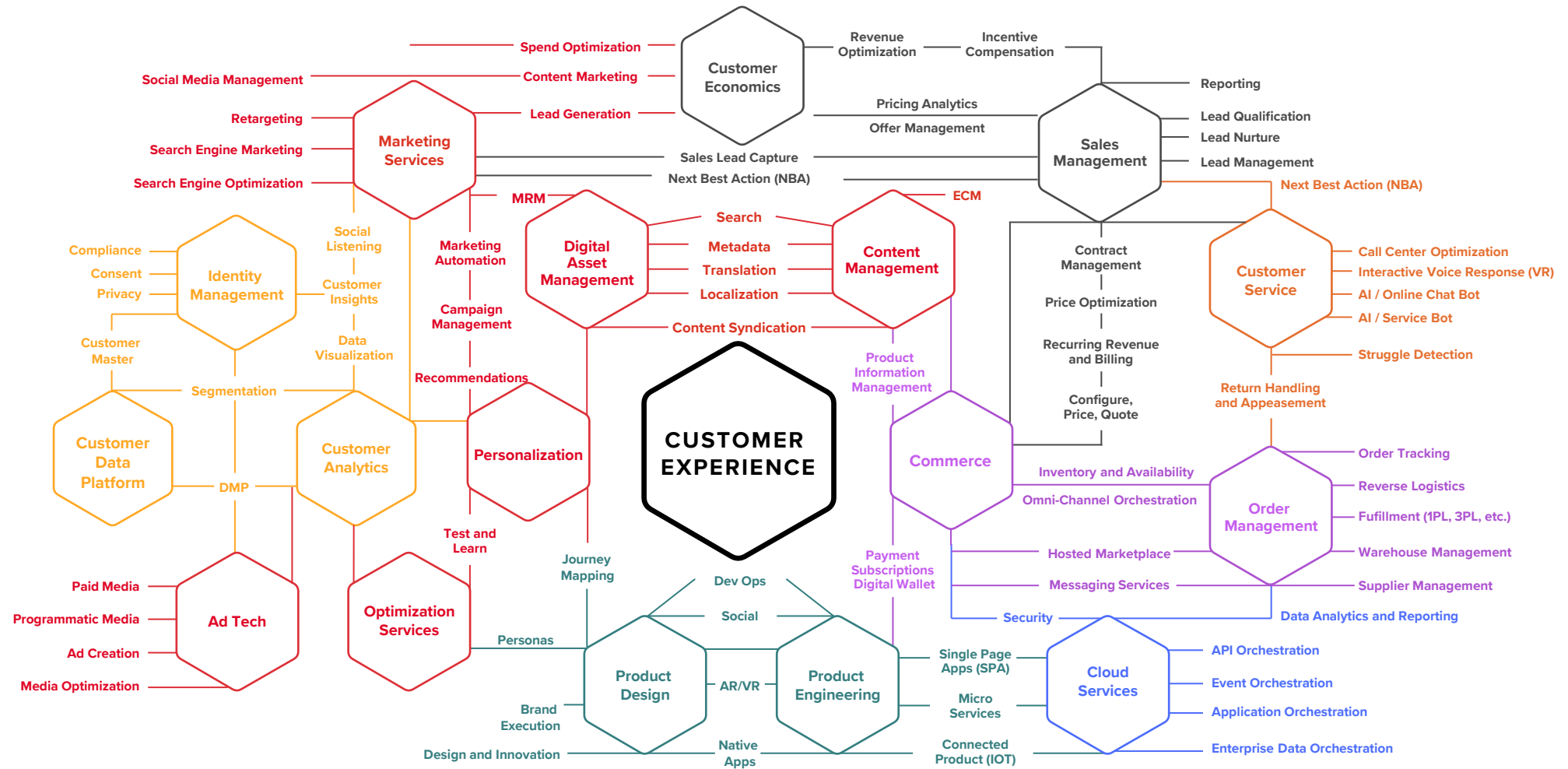
Profitability per Product Category

2.5x Brands expecting significantly higher profits in 5 years are 2.5x more likely to pursue ABM than those expecting a decline.

Call Center Reduction/ Deflection

Receive **much higher NPS scores** (+83 vs +23)
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

Visual model of the connected digital ecosystem



ACCOUNT-BASED

Everything

Champions: CEO, Board of Directors, C-Suite

ACCOUNT-BASED

Marketing

Audience: CMO, CDO, Product Marketing, Marketing Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Selling

Audience: CRO, CDO, CIO, CFO, Sales Operations, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Service & Advocacy

Audience: COO, CFO, CDO, CIO, Customer and Field Service, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Operations & Automation

Audience: COO, CFO, CDO, CIO, Customer and Field Service, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Everything

Champions: CEO, Board of Directors, C-Suite

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ACCOUNT-BASED

Operations & Automation

Audience: COO, CFO, CDO, CIO, Customer and Field Service, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Selling

Account-Based Selling is a highly targeted sales strategy to make teams more effective and efficient.

Sales and marketing teams work collaboratively to identify high-value accounts to engage and build personalized relationships with the goal of making sales cycles more autonomous and frictionless.

Sales Effectiveness

Provide capabilities to help sales teams cut through the noise and identify high value accounts and opportunities, engage with the right stakeholders, and deliver the right messaging.

Sales Efficiency

Provide experiences and capabilities to allow customers to self-service, automated certain tasks in order to give sales teams more time to focus on selling.



Our ABS Approach Transforms B2B Selling

Transitioning from a traditional B2B outside sales model to account-based selling, requires a fundamental **shift in strategy, execution, and measurement** to drive more impactful **business outcomes**.

TRADITIONAL B2B SELLING

ACCOUNT-BASED SELLING

Disconnected opportunity scoring between sales and marketing

Unified account and opportunity data across entire customer lifecycle

One size fits all approach to pipeline reporting and analysis

Data driven prioritization and next best action prompting

High volume of low value activity requires human interaction

Digitally enabled customer self service for all tasks

Swivel chair across many systems for sales and customers

Unified system of work for all commercial activity

Siloed commercial data across front, middle and back office

Integrated platforms for end-to-end data orchestration

Manual processes to facilitate tasks and communication

Automated workflows, queues and communication triggers

Inability to scale and grow without additional headcount

Ability to expand into new customers and markets through digital channels

ROI based on lead conversions or costs per lead

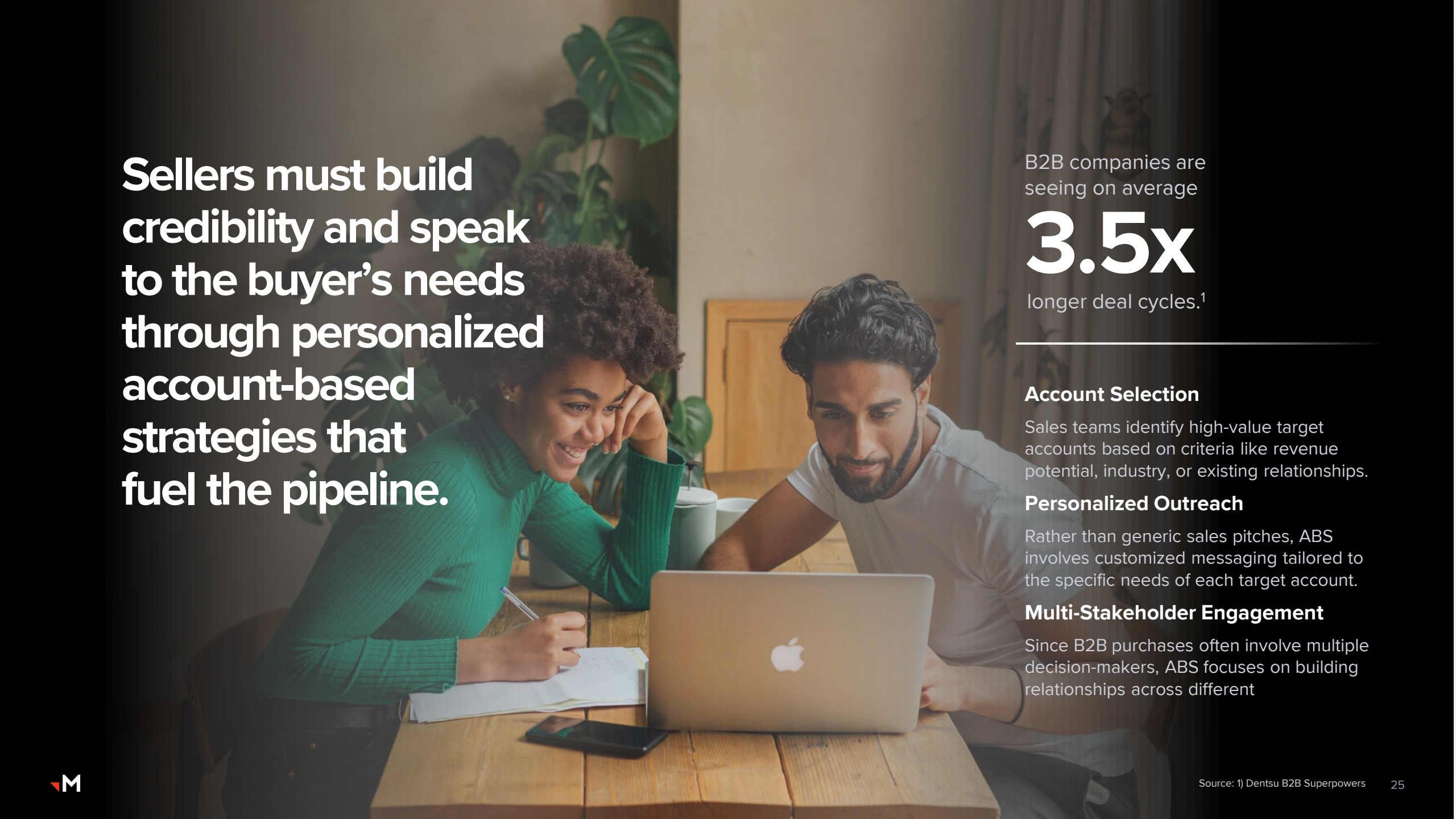
ROI measured on account lifetime value and deal acceleration

Key Sales Stakeholders

Though their motivations, and pain points vary, they must align to reach a shared success.



	Sales Manager	Sales Rep	Head of ecommerce	CIO/CDO
	“I need to provide an accurate forecast to management.”	“It is difficult to really know all of my customers’ needs.”	“I need to grow our ecommerce channel to achieve my targets”	“I need to harness our data while reducing technical debt.”
MOTIVATIONS	Accurate sales forecasting Territory revenue growth	Quota achievement Customer relationships	Top line channel revenue Customer satisfaction	Optimize technology costs Reduce technical debt Increase business collaboration
PAIN POINTS	Unpredictable close dates Pressure to do more with less	Too many accounts to actively manage all of them Difficult to identify key buying signals	Only certain product groups saleable via commerce Accurate pricing, entitlements, available to promise	Siloed systems and data Legacy ERP and back-office processes

A man and a woman are sitting at a wooden desk, looking at a laptop. The woman is on the left, wearing a green turtleneck, and the man is on the right, wearing a white t-shirt. They are both smiling and appear to be in a collaborative work environment. A large potted plant is visible in the background.

Sellers must build credibility and speak to the buyer's needs through personalized account-based strategies that fuel the pipeline.

B2B companies are seeing on average

3.5x

longer deal cycles.¹

Account Selection

Sales teams identify high-value target accounts based on criteria like revenue potential, industry, or existing relationships.

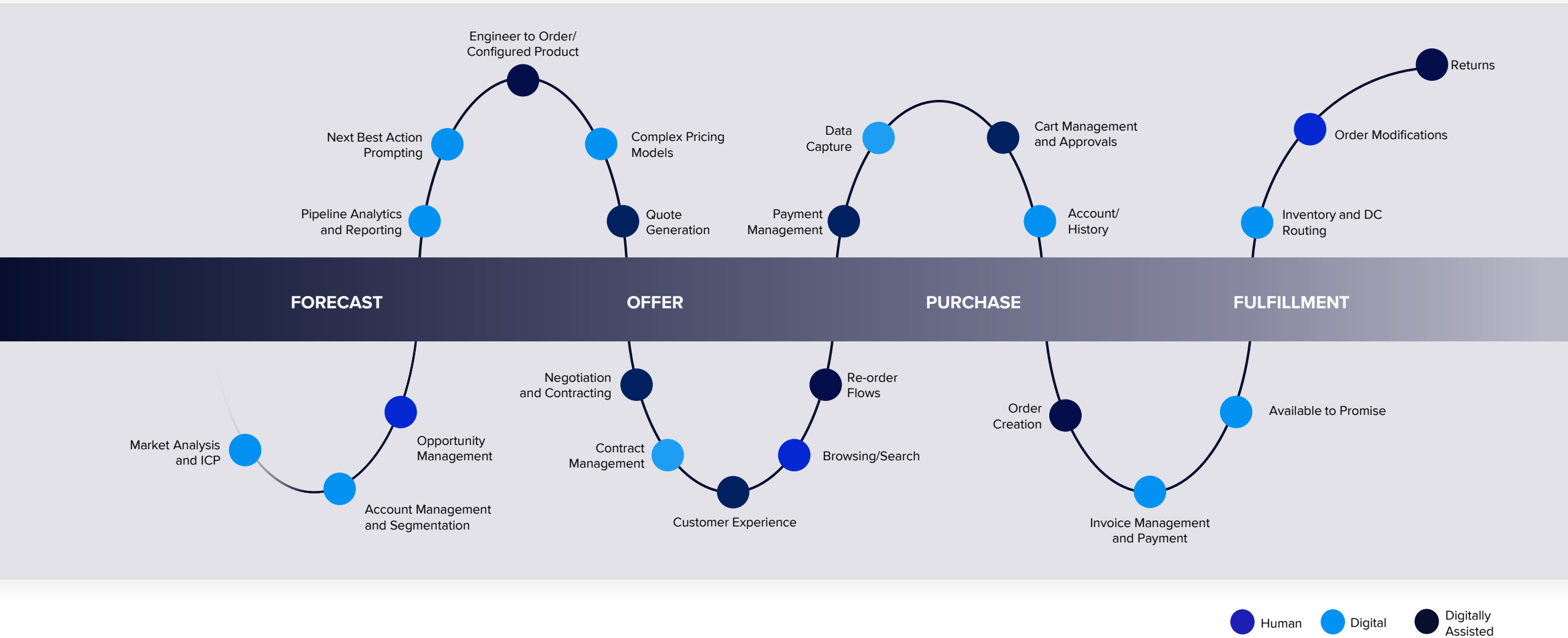
Personalized Outreach

Rather than generic sales pitches, ABS involves customized messaging tailored to the specific needs of each target account.

Multi-Stakeholder Engagement

Since B2B purchases often involve multiple decision-makers, ABS focuses on building relationships across different

Account based selling drives revenue growth



ACCOUNT-BASED SELLING

LEAD QUALIFICATION

MQL to SQL

- Pipeline automation
- AI-based MQL and SQL qualification criteria
- Next best sales action
- AI-based asset recommendations
- Automated team assignment
- Automated upline forecast reports
- Guided selling recommendations

OFFER CREATION

Sales Lead to Quote

CPQ

- Self-service product configuration
- Self-service quoting
- Automated quoting workflows
- AI-assisted negotiation and contracting
- Contract and quote management
- Pricing Analytics

PURCHASE

Quote to Cash

B2B Commerce

- Cross-sell / Up-sell offers
- AI-assisted product browsing and search
- Personalized product collateral
- Availability and inventory transparency and prompting
- Quote acceptance and order conversion
- Subscription / replenishment incentives
- Flexible payment enablement / options

B2B Marketplace

- Distributed supply chain
- Dropship
- Third-party fulfillment

FULFILLMENT

Order Orchestration

Order Orchestration

- Order tracking and fulfillment
- Smart routing and fulfillment
- Invoice and payment management
- Order notifications
- Self-service order modifications
- Returns and Appeasements

Digital Shelf Analytics

PART 2:

Case Studies and Why Merkle

This content provides reasons to believe that we are uniquely qualified to solve the client challenge presented in the preceding narrative.

Case studies should only be presented under NDA. If no NDA exists, the case studies should be blinded.

These slides are ready for client or prospect presentation.

Health Cloud implementation to spin-off a patient community

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

In BI USA, there was a lack of a centralized repository of IPF patient data that would serve to Clinical Educators to manage their relationships with them, storing their contact and medical information and organizing individual and group trainings about specific illness topics. From this need, NEST was created.

MERKLE SOLUTION

The system integrates with the Epsilon patient source database, allowing Clinical Educators to update patient status directly from Salesforce using the Health Cloud patient data model. Health Cloud serves as a reliable database of IPF patients. Using **NEST**, Clinical Educators can manage patient education via individual and group sessions.

Additionally, patient information is used in an invitation-only community called **EmpowerMe**. This community provides patients with information about their illnesses, webinars with experts, and access to testimonials from others with similar conditions. EmpowerMe was built in just four months and has been working flawlessly, showcasing the power of Salesforce Experience features. While patient logins and article views have increased, better advertising and more content could enhance its success.

+33k

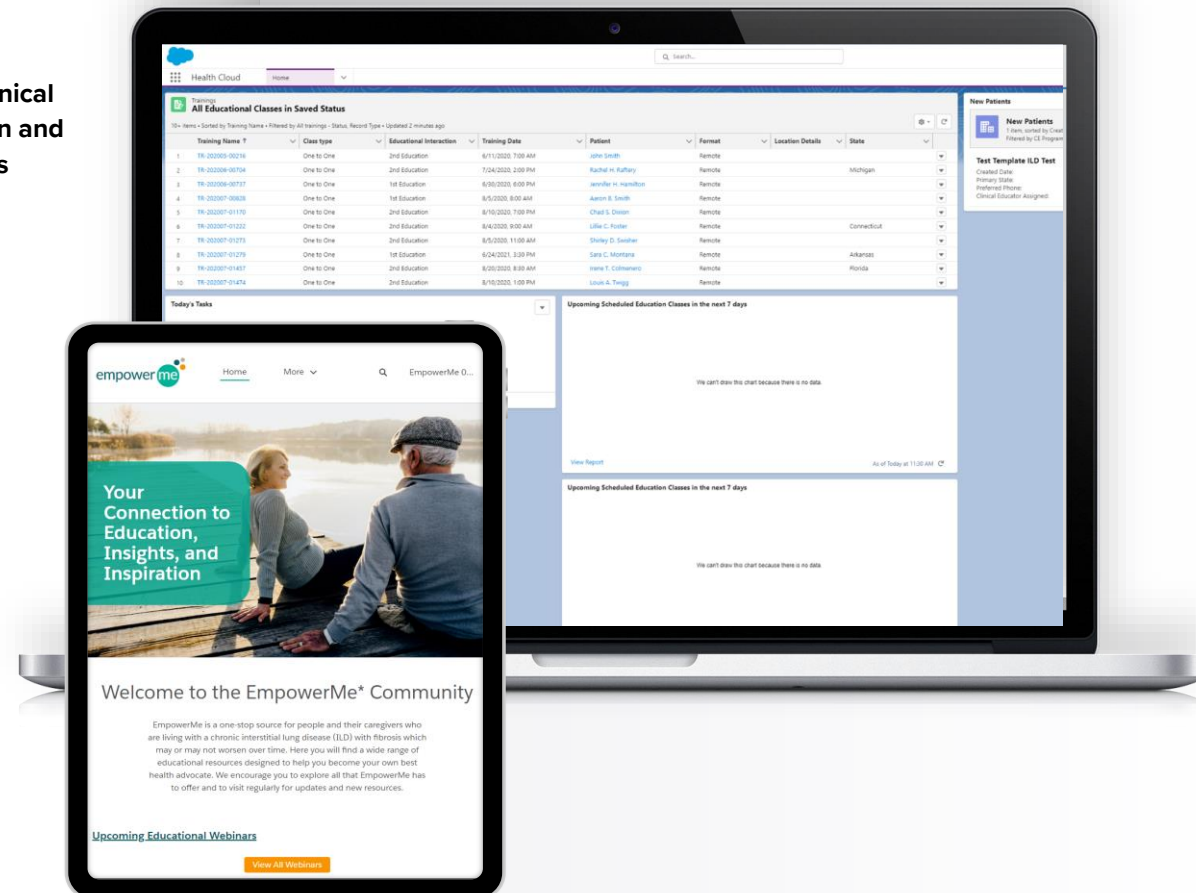
Patients
Reached

+2.8k

Community
Members

+650

Article
Views





Commercial transformation across sales and service

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Revamp the outdated custom-built ordering system to increase efficiencies, support commercial operations with a scalable tech architecture for growth plans.

MERKLE SOLUTION

We modernized the sales & service customer experience by creating two commerce storefront experiences – one for Allied’s 500 sellers, and one for its customers. In addition, we developed a scalable tech ecosystem that provides a comprehensive view of customers, integrates with other systems and supports multi-cloud environments.

- Salesforce B2B Commerce (& Merkle’s Rocket Accelerator)
- Salesforce Sales Cloud
- Salesforce Service Cloud
- MuleSoft

50%

Efficiencies gained in new customer service onboarding

300+

Sellers with transformed customer toolset



Digital transformation drives customer and business efficiencies.

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Tremco, a manufacturer of commercial sealants and waterproofing products, desired to modernize their current manual processes and offer self-service functionality to their customers.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Merkle designed Tremco's commerce platform to be a modern customer storefront with real-time integrations providing accurate product selections, pricing, and unit/quantity conversion. For Tremco's Sales Agents, a digital quoting tool with a robust guided selling functionality and customized reporting was created that improved efficiencies.

This project integrated multiple systems including:

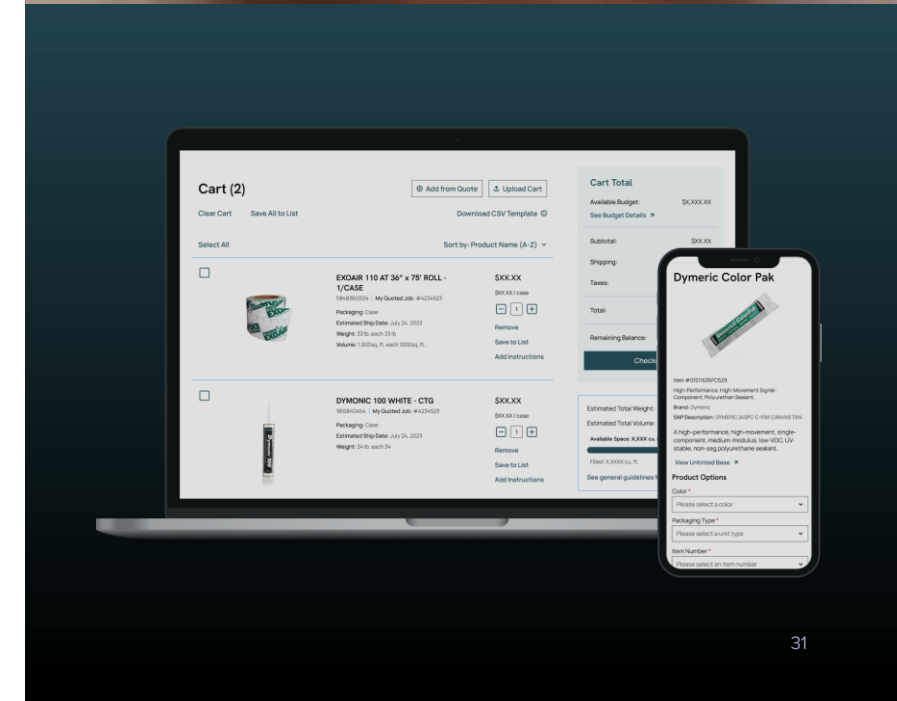
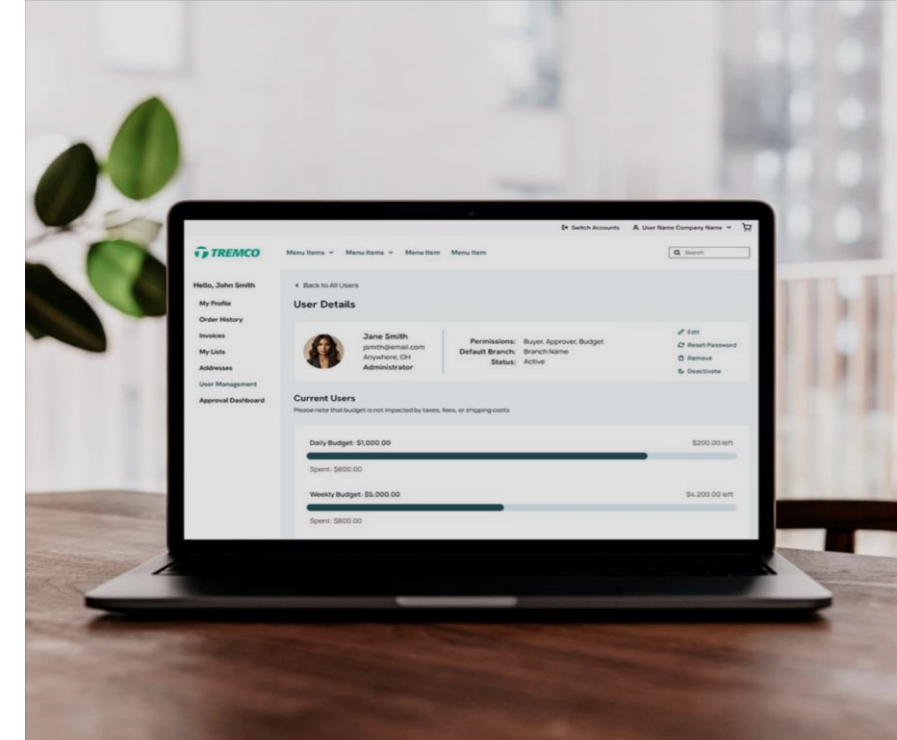
- Salesforce B2B Commerce, enhanced by Merkle's Rocket and PIM Accelerators
- Salesforce CPQ
- inriver PIM

\$9M USD

Revenue captured
in month 1

40%

Customer login rate
in first week



Digitizing the order-to-delivery journey for regulated products

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Westlake Chemical, a leader in highly regulated products like chlorine, faced challenges delivering a seamless customer experience across ordering, tracking, and documentation. Customers lacked a centralized way to manage orders, rail shipments, and critical docs like COAs and invoices in real time. Each business unit also struggled to scale lead generation, product launches, and account growth due to fragmented marketing systems.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Merkle partnered with Westlake Chemical to build a secure, self-service portal that streamlines the full order lifecycle—from online purchasing to real-time tracking, across modes. Customers can access onboarding workflows, COAs, invoices, and order history instantly. Each business unit can drive leads, launch new products, and deliver ABX strategies through the portal, powered by fully integrated SF Marketing Cloud.

B2B Commerce:

- Salesforce B2B Commerce (Rocket Acceleration)
- Salesforce Sales & Service
- Salesforce B2B Lightning
- Salesforce Communities
- SAP ERP
- Salesforce Marketing Cloud Engagement



SATAIR

Digital modernization drives results across the business.

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Satair, an Airbus company, supplies parts for much of the aviation industry. They sought a total experience-led digital transformation of their business, to drive growth and customer satisfaction, while also driving efficiency and modern ways of working in the business.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Merkle supported Satair in developing their digital north star, and delivering a transformation program that digitized their business, sales and service flows, saving Satair and their clients time and money.

Built on a best-in-class commerce, experience, and marketing tech stack, Satair's award-winning customer, employee, and partner experience has evolved to drive over 50% of their business fully digital.

- End-to-end digital strategy and service design, design and technology build, and transformation and change management
- AI-powered customer service automation and eCommerce journeys
- New marketplace business model and Mirakl-powered platform
- Predictive service, forecasting, and ordering experiences

\$1B USD

From no digital selling to 50% of business digital, and \$1B in new eCommerce revenue from a global marketplace

240 hours

Hours saved for the average Satair customer every year from digitization



PART 3:

Wedges and Engagements

This content outlines the various packages you can sell within this offering. The wedges, or door openers, are priced to help get the first sale. The engagements fit various needs related to the offering. Put one or a few in front of your client, based on their needs.

These slides are ready for client or prospect presentation.

MQL to SQL

Turn your ambition to grow strategic accounts into a focused, actionable ABM plan.

Our data-driven approach helps you define the right goals, target accounts, and cross-functional approach to maximize relevance and results.



Our Approach

Transform your selling approach with highly targeted data driven strategies.

Your Challenges

- Effective guided sales directs and supports sellers through their sales process. Businesses need to address the unique challenges to offer seamless and comprehensive experiences for their B2B clients while ensuring maximum efficiency and standards.

Our Solution

- Discovery: Create a future state plan of a sales funnel infused with AI including definition of Next Based Action
- Design: Evaluate the existing processes and how to mold them to the future state vision
- Build: AI and Sales CRM, CPQ, and other tool integration
- Testing with various sales roles and groups prior to rollout
- Training and change management
- Rollout to all global teams and groups

What You Get

- Improve sales efficiency (process standardization and automation)
- Improve collaboration and customer relation (remove silos and enable 360° View)
- Improve sales process and drive growth (conversion rate and cross-/up-sell)

Representative
Clients:



CPQ

Enable smart and simple buying and selling processes for complex products and bundles.

Our Approach

Efficiently generate quotes based on past performance and minimal intervention.

Your Challenges

- Poor customer buying experience for complex products
- Inaccurate or non-compliant pricing due to lack of governance and automation
- Extensive manual steps to produce a quote and lack of visibility

Our Solution

- Enable smart and simple configuration processes for complex products and bundles.
- Accurately price ETO, MTO, configured skus, and bundles based on complex rules
- Automate quoting and contracting flows to provide speed, transparency, and accuracy

What You Get

- Customer self service for your most complex items with advanced configurators
- Unified pricing engine built on rules-based models
- Automated quoting workflows with triggered internal and external communications

Representative
Clients:

COORSTEK
Amazing Solutions

RPM

OFFER CREATION

Pricing Analytics

Unlocking revenue growth through strategic pricing



Our Approach

Personalize pricing by individual customer and user.

Your Challenges

- Pricing decisions based on intuition rather than data-driven insights
- Inconsistent pricing processes and uncontrolled discount leakage
- Limited visibility into price elasticity and customer willingness to pay
- Manual pricing workflows that slow time-to-market and deal closure
- Inability to optimize margins while maintaining competitive positioning

Our Solution

- Strategic pricing frameworks with value-based architecture design
- Advanced analytics for price optimization and customer segmentation
- Automated pricing workflows and intelligent approval processes
- AI-powered scenario analysis and dynamic pricing triggers
- Integrated technology stack with real-time pricing engines

What You Get*

- 2-5% margin improvement through optimized pricing strategies
- 40-60% reduction in pricing cycle time via automation
- Data-driven pricing decisions with real-time market intelligence
- Competitive differentiation through next-gen pricing capabilities
- Scalable pricing operations aligned with business growth

Representative
Clients:

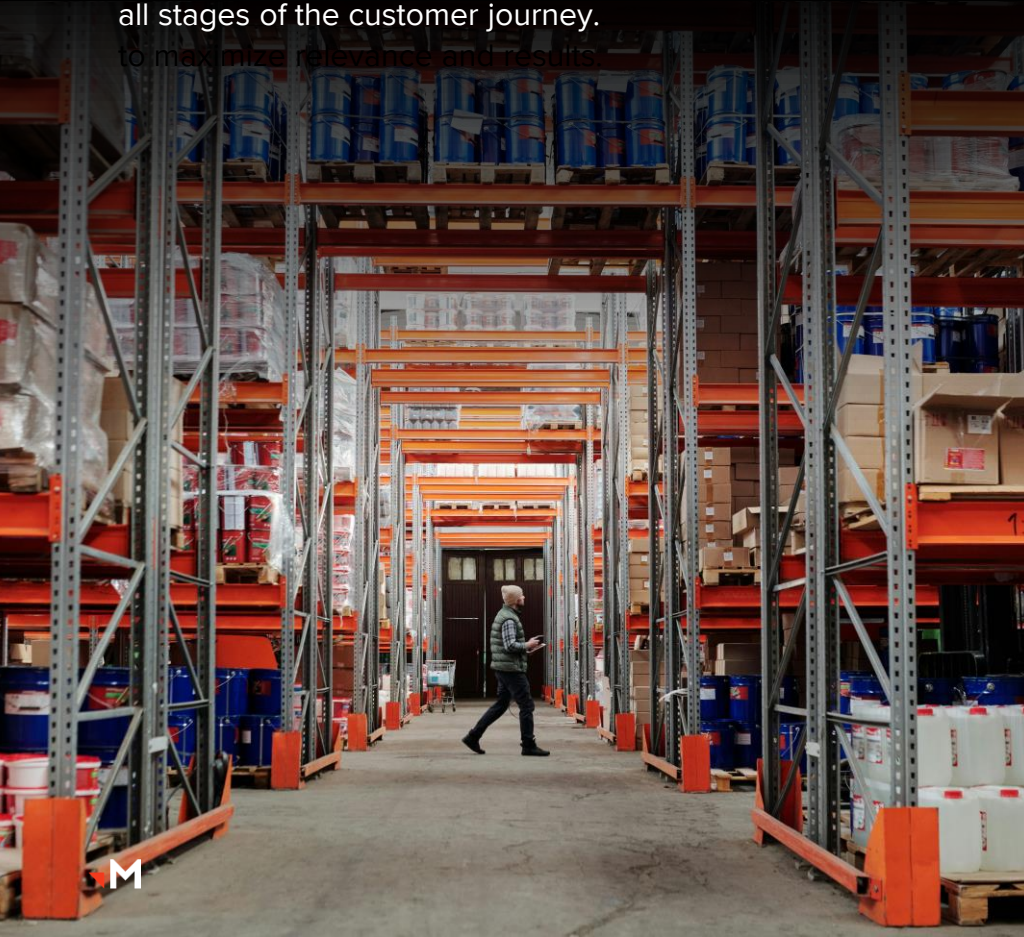


PURCHASE

B2B Commerce

Commerce is a key driver in reducing customer cost to service and capturing revenue growth opportunities. B2B Commerce is a cohesive digital experiences that allow customers to receive contextual commercial interactions at all stages of the customer journey.

to maximize relevance and results



Our Approach

B2B Commerce accelerates growth, lowers costs, and deepens customer relationships by delivering a seamless, data-driven digital buying experience.

Your Challenges

- Inefficient operations from manual, error-prone order and service processes.
- Limited growth due to restricted sales channels and poor scalability.
- Weak customer experience with no real-time, self-service buying

Our Solution

- Customer-facing storefront — personalized catalogs, contract pricing, bulk ordering, and account-specific promotions.
- Self-service capabilities — order history, reordering, shipment tracking, invoice access, and returns.
- Integration with back-office systems — ERP, CRM, OMS, PIM, and inventory for real-time pricing, stock, and order status.
- Advanced search and navigation — product filtering, configurations, and recommendations.
- Mobile-optimized experience — responsive design for buyers in the field or on-site.
- B2B-specific workflows — approvals, quotes, credit terms, and multi-user account management.

What You Get

- Decrease cost to service across sales and service (call deflection)
- Increase customer acquisition rates
- Increase average account value (cross-sell, sales velocity)
- Increase customer retention (great customer experience)

Representative
Clients:



B2B Marketplace

Supply chain is more important than ever. Optimizing the supply chain via dropship and third-party marketplace experiences enables the ability to test and learn new product categories and increase SKU profitability.



Our Approach

Expand your sales reach with B2B Commerce through integrated third-party and dropship seller networks, creating a comprehensive digital marketplace that scales product offerings while optimizing operational efficiency.

Your Challenges

- Limited product catalog constrains growth
- High inventory costs and storage complexity for expanding SKU range
- Regional fulfillment gaps limiting market reach
- Complex seller/vendor onboarding processes causing delays and partner friction
- Difficulty maintaining quality control across distributed seller network

Our Solution

- Holistic vision for B2B Commerce (1P, Dropship, 3P)
- Business value case for B2B marketplace
- Merchandising / Category strategy for marketplace categories (Dropship, 3P)
- Comprehensive business process and operating protocol designs
- Platform recommendation, implementation, and integration
- Seller / Vendor onboarding facilitation (pilot and ongoing)
- Seller training and change management

What You Get

- SKU profitability uplift
- Category expansion
- Optimized regional fulfillment
- Seller diversification
- Revenue growth

Representative
Clients:

AIRBUS

ULTA
BEAUTY

Order Orchestration

Our solution offers a one-stop shop for all order data, providing full visibility and real-time notifications of any exceptions. This eliminates the need for manual tracking and "swivel chair" processes, streamlining operations and improving efficiency.

It maximizes performance and results.

Our Approach

Provide automation that allows customers to order how they want.

Your Challenges

- Most B2B orders still come in through offline channels or EDI
- Orders may need to be fulfilled across multiple ERPs
- Many orders require manual re-keying by customer service and exceptions lack visibility

Our Solution

- Automate order ingestion with intelligent AI driven processing for structured and unstructured data
- Quickly identify and automate resolution of exceptions
- Provide a single system of work for order visibility and management

What You Get

- Decrease cost to service across sales and service (call deflection)
- Increase order accuracy
- Reduce revenue leakage through robust exception management
- Seamless customer experience for ordering through all channels

Representative
Clients:



Westlake
Chemical



Formerra

Digital Shelf Analytics

Assess brand compliance across various KPIs like content, price, promo, ratings and reviews, visibility and more with an AI-powered platform to take a data-driven approach to measure, benchmark and improve channel performance across retailers, markets, competitors.

to maximize relevance and results

Our Approach

Track your brand across channels.

Your Challenges

- Inconsistent customer experience across Retailer platforms tarnishing brand image.
- Low competitor visibility with strategy, pricing, promotions and availability across retailer platforms.
- Model media spends on RMNs / on Retailer platforms to drive ROAS. Understanding promotion cycles across Retailer platforms and competition positioning

Our Solution

- Conduct discovery sessions to understand brands business needs to spearhead e-commerce sales
- Identify retailer platforms, competitors and metrics that define a winning strategy for the team
- Collect information and trends across retailer platforms to analyze trends impacting performance
- Work with commerce and media teams to develop strategies that help win the digital shelf across markets, retailers and competitors

What You Get

- An always-on dashboard showcasing insights across key KPIs impacting performance
- Regular cadence with client teams highlighting key changes and impact on strategy

Representative
Clients:



Additional Digital Shelf Analytics content is found here

<https://globalappsportal.sharepoint.com/sites/MerkleBusinessArchitectureGTM/SitePages/Digital%20Shelf.aspx>

PART 4: Training

The aim of this **INTERNAL ONLY** section is for sales teams to learn the details of the offering, how it fits in the overall Merkle capability landscape, the various packages you can sell within this offering based on client needs, and how to sell it to clients and prospects.

Market Contacts

STEVE
CONWAY



**B2B Transformation
Solution Lead**
VP – B2B, Commerce,
Marketplace Solutions

STEVE
DURAN



**B2B
Transformation
Growth Lead**
VP – CX&C GTM

NICK
SCHULTE



**Salesforce B2B
Lead**
VP – Salesforce
GTM

CHRIS
KOSTAKIS



**B2B Technology
Lead**
SVP – CX&C
Technology

MIKE
BRUNST



**Executive Sales
Lead**
EVP – CX&C

ERIC BUSS



Executive Sponsor
EVP – CX&C

B2B Transformation: Account-Based Selling



Buyers and Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

PRIMARY AUDIENCE

CRO/VP Sales, CDO/CTO/VP Commerce, CIO

Concern #1

Sales teams lack integrated tools to streamline quoting, pricing, and order processes, resulting in slow quote-to-cash cycles, revenue leakage, and poor customer experience.

Concern #2

Disconnected systems prevent accurate forecasting and visibility into account behavior, causing inventory issues, missed opportunities, and inability to proactively serve accounts.

Concern #3

Manual processes and lack of digital commerce capabilities limit account growth, increase cost-to-serve, and prevent sales teams from identifying expansion opportunities across their portfolio.

PRIMARY OUTCOMES

Outcome	Why it Matters
Quote-to-Cash Cycle Time	Measures end-to-end efficiency from quote generation through order fulfillment. Best-in-class B2B organizations achieve 24–48-hour cycles versus industry average of 5-7 days. Integrated quoting, pricing, and order management systems reduce friction, accelerate revenue recognition, and improve customer experience. Every day reduced increases customer satisfaction by 3-5 points and win rates by 2-4%.
Forecast Accuracy Rate	Measures predictability of revenue within target accounts as percentage variance between forecasted and actual bookings. Mature ABS platforms with integrated CRM, quoting, and order data achieve 90-95% accuracy versus 70-75% in siloed systems. This precision enables better resource allocation, inventory planning, and investor confidence while reducing costly expedited fulfillment and margin erosion.
Digital Engagement and Self-Service Adoption Rate	Tracks percentage of account transactions flowing through B2B commerce portals and marketplace channels versus manual processes. Leading organizations achieve 60-75% digital adoption, reducing cost-to-serve by 40-60% while freeing sales teams for strategic activities. Digital shelf analytics reveal buying patterns, enabling proactive replenishment and personalized offers that increase order frequency by 25-40%.
Price Realization / Margin Optimization	Measures actual contracted pricing versus list price, revealing effectiveness of dynamic pricing and discount governance. Strategic pricing tools improve margin by 2-5 percentage points by eliminating maverick discounting, enabling value-based pricing for different account segments, and providing sales teams with AI-driven guidance. Tracks quote approval cycle time and discount variance across tiers.
Account Penetration and Wallet Share Growth	Measures expansion across product categories, business units, and locations within target accounts. Integration of commerce data, digital shelf insights, and CRM reveals white space opportunities. Best-in-class programs grow wallet share from 15-20% to 40-60% within 24 months by identifying unmet needs through analytics, enabling cross-category recommendations, and streamlining reordering through marketplace capabilities.

B2B Transformation: Account-Based Selling



Buyers and Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

TARGET INDUSTRIES

Describe specific industries or verticals where this offering is particularly relevant.

Industry	Why it Matters	Do we have vertical-specific content?
Industrial Distribution and Manufacturing	Complex product catalogs (100K+ SKUs), multi-location buying centers, and lengthy procurement cycles demand integrated quoting, dynamic pricing, and self-service portals. Quote-to-cash efficiency directly impacts customer retention in markets where 60% of buyers prefer digital ordering. Digital shelf analytics reveal which products drive repeat purchases across contractor and MRO segments.	IN PROCESS
Automotive and Tire Manufacturing	Dealer networks and fleet accounts demand real-time pricing, configure-price-quote (CPQ) for complex product bundles, and integrated order-to-fulfillment visibility. Account penetration tracking reveals opportunities across OEM parts, aftermarket, and fleet services. Digital commerce reduces cost-to-serve for high-volume, low-touch transactions while sales focuses on strategic fleet relationships.	IN PROCESS
Building Materials and Home Improvement	Pro and contractor segments represent 40-50% of revenue but require specialized pricing, job-site delivery coordination, and project-based quoting. Account-based selling with integrated order management enables tracking across multiple job sites per account. Digital shelf analytics identify seasonal buying patterns and cross-category opportunities (lumber → fasteners → tools). Self-service portals reduce cost-to-serve for repeat purchases while sales focuses on large project bids.	IN PROCESS
Healthcare and Medical Device Distribution	Hospital systems and group purchasing organizations (GPOs) involve complex buying committees, compliance requirements, and contract pricing across multiple facilities. Forecast accuracy is critical for inventory management of time-sensitive products. Account penetration tracking reveals expansion opportunities across departments, locations, and service lines. Integrated quoting and order management ensure regulatory compliance while reducing procurement cycle time from 45+ days to under 20.	IN PROCESS
Retail and Specialty Retail	Omnichannel B2B relationships (franchise, wholesale, vendor partnerships) require sophisticated order management and forecasting to balance inventory across channels. Marketplace capabilities enable 3P seller onboarding to expand assortment without inventory risk. Price optimization across B2B tiers (wholesale vs. franchise) protects margins while growing wallet share within strategic accounts.	IN PROCESS



PART 4: TRAINING

B2B Transformation:
Account-Based Selling

Commercial Guidance

Guidance on price point, market size, and competitive landscape for an offering in a given market.

Client-facing pricing slides for each engagement can be found on slides in the what we sell section of this toolkit.



Key competitors	Name: McKinsey & Company / Boston Consulting Group (BCG) Description: Top-tier strategy consultancies providing B2B transformation vision and business case development. Strong C-suite relationships but typically hand off implementation. Merkle Differentiation: End-to-end execution from strategy through platform deployment and ongoing optimization	Name: Accenture Interactive (Accenture Song) Description: Largest digital consultancy with massive scale and global delivery. Competes on enterprise B2B transformations for Fortune 500. Merkle Differentiation: More agile engagement models, deeper commerce specialization, integrated marketing/commerce vs. siloed practices
	Name: PwC Digital / EY Consulting / KPMG Advisory Description: Big Four expanding into digital transformation and commerce. Strong in enterprise architecture and compliance, less differentiated in CX design and marketing technology. Merkle Differentiation: Superior experience design and integrated marketing/commerce capabilities	Name: Deloitte Digital / Cognizant / Infosys / Wipro / TCS Description: Large-scale system integrators competing on complex, multi-year implementations. Cost-competitive but less emphasis on customer experience. Merkle Differentiation: Experience-led transformation and measurement/optimization post-launch vs. technical delivery focus
	Name: Bain & Company Description: Strategy consultancy with strong PE relationships and results-oriented B2B transformation approach. Limited hands-on commerce platform implementation. Merkle Differentiation: Full-service capability combining strategic vision with technical execution	
Key Alliances	Adobe Salesforce Mirakl commercetools SAP Oracle VTEX Shopify Plus Merkle maintains premier/platinum partnerships with leading commerce and marketplace platforms, providing co-innovation opportunities, preferential pricing, and joint go-to-market initiatives. Unlike competitors tied to single platforms, Merkle's vendor-agnostic approach enables objective technology selection—then leverages deep platform expertise to accelerate implementation and reduce risk.	

B2B Transformation: Account-Based Selling



Why Merkle

Merkle is uniquely positioned to help our clients thrive and win in the current landscape. Understand how the Merkle story resonates in this context and grab relevant case studies.

OUR STORY: KEY DIFFERENTIATORS

Strategy + Execution in One Partner: We architect transformation roadmaps AND build them—bridging the gap between pure strategy firms (McKinsey, Bain) and offshore implementers (Cognizant, Infosys). No handoffs, no gaps.

Proprietary Data and Identity Assets: Merkury identity resolution and audience syndication capabilities enable account-level personalization and analytics that generic commerce platforms can't deliver. We connect anonymous behavior to known accounts for smarter engagement.

Proven Retail and B2B Commerce Depth: Deep vertical expertise in retail, industrial distribution, and manufacturing with live marketplace implementations proving we execute at scale.

Platform-Agnostic Excellence: Premier partnerships with Adobe, Salesforce, Mirakl, SAP, commercetools allow objective technology selection vs. competitors locked into single platforms. We recommend what's best for you, then execute flawlessly.

Marketing + Commerce + Supply Chain Integration: Unlike pure commerce SIs, we connect the full customer journey—from account-based marketing through transaction, fulfillment, and retention analytics. Performance marketing DNA drives measurable ROI, not just deployment.

OUR WORK

Client	Project	Market	Description	Link to case
Formerra	IN PROCESS			
Lincoln Electric	IN PROCESS			
RPM	IN PROCESS			

MARKET VALIDATION

Analyst	Report Name	Ranking Name	Year
Forrester	The Forrester Wave™: B2B Commerce Suites	Merkle (Dentsu) recognized as Strong Performer in B2B Commerce Services	2024
Gartner	Magic Quadrant for Digital Commerce	Merkle recognized for B2B Commerce Implementation Services	2024
IDC	IDC MarketScape: Worldwide Digital Commerce Services	Named as Major Player in Digital Commerce Consulting and Implementation	2024



B2B Transformation: Account-Based Selling



Sales Guidance

Help selling through the offering, from handling objections to understanding similar/competitive offerings where they exist.

GUIDANCE AND GUIDELINES

Key Messaging Points

Position Merkle as the bridge between marketing/analytics sophistication (where retail excels) and B2B revenue optimization (where most lag)

Emphasize Board-level metrics: wallet share growth, forecast accuracy, margin expansion, capital efficiency through marketplace models

Merkle uniquely combines strategic vision with execution expertise plus proprietary data assets (Merkury) that drive measurable outcomes

Common Objections and Responses

"This feels like a multi-year, high-risk transformation"

We deliver in phases with ROI gates. First phase (marketplace pilot or portal MVP) launches in 4-6 months with early wins funding expansion

"Our B2B business model is different—we can't just replicate D2C or other B2B companies"

Exactly—B2B requires account-specific pricing, approval workflows, and credit terms. We architect for your complexity while elevating experience

"We're already working with [Accenture/Deloitte/Publicis]"

We can complement their strategy with specialized B2B commerce execution, or take full ownership from strategy through optimization

WHAT TO LISTEN FOR

- As you think about your growth strategy over the next 3-5 years, how important is B2B revenue (wholesale, franchise, marketplace, trade) relative to D2C in reaching your targets?
- How would you characterize your organization's B2B digital maturity compared to your D2C capabilities—are they at parity, or is B2B operating with legacy processes and technology?
- What would unlocking an additional 20-30% wallet share from your existing B2B accounts mean to your overall growth plan, and what's currently preventing that expansion?
- If you could create the same seamless, data-driven buying experience for B2B partners that you've built for D2C customers, what business outcomes would that enable?
- Have you evaluated launching a third-party marketplace to expand assortment and enhance supply chain efficiency?
- How confident are you in your organization's ability to forecast B2B demand, optimize pricing across account tiers, and measure the true profitability of your B2B channels?
- What does your executive team see as the biggest risk to B2B growth—technology limitations, organizational structure, competitive threats, or something else?
- If you could solve one strategic challenge in B2B that would fundamentally change your competitive position or margin profile, what would it be?

QUALIFYING QUESTIONS

- What percentage of your total revenue comes from B2B channels (wholesale, franchisees, marketplace sellers, trade partners) versus D2C, and how is that mix expected to change?
- How do your wholesale/franchise/B2B partners currently place orders and access product information—is it the same experience as your D2C customers, or separate systems?
- When you think about customer acquisition cost and lifetime value metrics on the D2C side, do you have similar visibility into the economics of your B2B accounts and what drives their repeat purchase behavior?
- Do your B2B partners (franchisees, wholesale accounts, marketplace sellers) have access to the same product content, digital assets, and merchandising tools that drive conversion on your D2C site?
- How personalized is the buying experience for your different B2B segments—can you show different pricing, products, or promotions based on account type the way you do audience segmentation in D2C?
- What's preventing your B2B accounts from transacting more like your D2C customers (self-service, real-time inventory, instant checkout)—is it technology, business model, or something else?
- When you analyze your D2C customer data and buying patterns, do you have similar insights into what products different B2B accounts are buying, what they're NOT buying from you, and where you're losing to competitors?

PART 4: TRAINING

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B TRANSFORMATION: ACCOUNT-BASED SELLING

MQL to SQL

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

B2B sales teams struggle to efficiently convert marketing-qualified leads into sales-qualified opportunities due to disconnected systems, manual processes, and lack of account-level intelligence. Sales reps spend excessive time on low-quality leads while high-value accounts lack personalized engagement, resulting in poor conversion rates and extended sales cycles.

OBJECTIVE

Transform lead qualification into a data-driven, AI-enabled process that prioritizes high-value accounts, automates routine tasks, and provides sales teams with actionable intelligence. Integrate CRM, CPQ, and analytics to create a seamless handoff from marketing to sales with clear next-best-actions, improving conversion rates and shortening time-to-close.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

- Account-Based Experience (ABE) Platform: Extend MQL-to-SQL foundation with personalized portal experiences for target accounts
- Sales Forecasting and Pipeline Analytics: Build predictive models to improve forecast accuracy and identify at-risk deals
- B2B Commerce Portal Integration: Connect qualified accounts directly to self-service ordering capabilities
- Revenue Operations Optimization: Expand automation across quote-to-cash cycle

CLIENT

Printpack, USG, Formerra

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

- Discovery: Create a future state plan of a sales funnel infused with AI including definition of Next Best Action
- Design: Evaluate the existing processes and how to mold them to the future state vision
- Build: AI and Sales CRM, CPQ, and other tool integration
- Testing: Testing with various sales roles and groups prior to rollout
- Training: Training and change management
- Rollout: Rollout to all global teams and groups

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

- Merkurs Identity Resolution: Connect anonymous digital behavior to known accounts for better lead scoring
- AI-Powered Lead Scoring Models: Proprietary algorithms to predict conversion likelihood and account value
- Next Best Action Engine: AI-driven recommendations for sales engagement at each funnel stage
- Account Intelligence Dashboard: 360° view combining CRM, engagement, and behavioral data
- Sales Playbook Framework: Proven methodologies for account prioritization and engagement sequencing

Investment: \$200K-\$500K

Timing: 12-24 weeks

Outcomes:

- **Improve sales efficiency** through process standardization and automation, reducing time spent on low-quality leads by 30-40%
- **Improve collaboration and customer relation** by removing silos and enabling 360° account view across marketing, sales, and service teams
- **Improve sales process and drive growth** by increasing conversion rates 25-35% and accelerating deal velocity through cross-sell/upsell identification
- **Increase forecast accuracy** from 70-75% to 90-95% through integrated data and AI-driven pipeline analysis

PART 4: TRAINING

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B TRANSFORMATION: ACCOUNT-BASED SELLING

CPQ

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

B2B organizations with complex product catalogs, configurable SKUs, and custom pricing models struggle with slow, error-prone quoting processes. Sales teams lack tools to accurately price engineered-to-order (ETO) and made-to-order (MTO) products, resulting in margin leakage from inconsistent discounting, extended quote cycles that lose deals to faster competitors, and poor customer experience due to manual back-and-forth during configuration

OBJECTIVE

Implement a Configure-Price-Quote (CPQ) solution that automates complex product configuration, enforces pricing rules and discount governance, and accelerates quote-to-cash cycles. Integrate CPQ with CRM, ERP, and commerce platforms to provide sales teams with guided selling tools, real-time pricing accuracy, and automated approval workflows that improve win rates while protecting margins

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

- **B2B Commerce Portal Integration:** Connect CPQ to self-service portals enabling customers to configure and order complex products without sales assistance
- **Dynamic Pricing Optimization:** Advanced rules engine with AI-driven pricing recommendations based on account value, competition, and market conditions
- **Order Management System (OMS) Integration:** Seamless handoff from quote to order fulfillment with real-time status visibility
- **Sales Performance Analytics:** Dashboard tracking quote velocity, win rates, discount patterns, and margin realization by rep and account

CLIENT

CoorsTek, RPM International

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

- **Discovery:** Audit existing quoting processes, product configuration rules, pricing models, and approval workflows to identify bottlenecks and margin leakage
- **Design:** Configure product catalog structure, pricing logic, discount matrices, approval hierarchies, and guided selling flows optimized for sales efficiency
- **Build:** Integrate CPQ platform (Salesforce CPQ, SAP CPQ, Oracle CPQ, or similar) with CRM, ERP, PIM, and commerce systems for seamless data flow
- **Testing:** Validate configuration rules, pricing accuracy, and workflow automation with sales teams across product lines and customer segments
- **Training:** Comprehensive sales enablement including product configuration training, pricing guidance, and workflow navigation
- **Rollout:** Phased deployment starting with highest-complexity product lines, expanding to full catalog with ongoing optimization

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

- **CPQ Implementation Accelerators:** Pre-built templates for common B2B industries (industrial distribution, manufacturing, building materials)
- **Pricing Rules Framework:** Proven methodologies for tier-based pricing, volume discounts, and contract pricing management
- **Product Configuration Logic:** Structured approach to building complex configuration rules for ETO/MTO products
- **Quote-to-Order Integration Patterns:** Best practices for connecting CPQ to commerce, ERP, and order management systems
- **Sales Enablement Playbooks:** Training frameworks for driving CPQ adoption and ensuring sales team proficiency

Investment: \$400K – \$1.5m

Timing: 12-24 weeks

Outcomes:

- **Reduce quote cycle time by 40-60%** through automated configuration, pricing, and approval workflows, enabling sales to respond to RFQs in hours instead of days
- **Improve margin realization by 2-5 percentage points** through enforced discount governance, tier-based pricing rules, and elimination of maverick pricing
- **Increase quote-to-win conversion rates by 20-30%** by providing faster, more accurate quotes with professional presentation and real-time product availability
- **Enable customer self-service for complex products** with guided configuration tools, reducing cost-to-serve and freeing sales for strategic account development

PART 4: TRAINING

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B TRANSFORMATION: ACCOUNT-BASED SELLING

Pricing Analytics

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

B2B organizations struggle with intuition-based pricing decisions resulting in margin leakage and missed revenue opportunities. Inconsistent discounting, limited visibility into price elasticity, and manual workflows slow deal closure while competitors with dynamic pricing capture market share. Organizations lack tools to optimize margins while maintaining competitive positioning across account segments.

OBJECTIVE

Deploy AI-powered pricing analytics that transform pricing from reactive guesswork into a strategic growth lever. Implement real-time optimization with market intelligence, customer segmentation, and scenario modeling. Integrate with CRM, CPQ, and commerce platforms to automate intelligent pricing recommendations and approval workflows.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

- **Dynamic Pricing Engine:** Real-time optimization based on demand, competition, inventory, and customer behavior
- **Customer Segmentation and Willingness-to-Pay Analysis:** Price sensitivity modeling across account tiers
- **Competitive Price Monitoring:** Automated competitor tracking with alert triggers
- **Margin Optimization Dashboard:** Executive analytics on price realization and discount variance

Client names

Kmart

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

- **Discovery:** Audit pricing models, discount structures, and transaction data to identify margin leakage and opportunities
- **Design:** Build strategic pricing frameworks with value-based architecture, segmentation models, and dynamic pricing rules
- **Build:** Implement pricing analytics platform with AI/ML models, integrate with CPQ/commerce for automated recommendations
- **Testing:** Validate through scenario analysis and pilot programs across select product categories and segments
- **Training:** Enable pricing teams and sales leadership with analytics interpretation and optimization methodologies
- **Rollout:** Phased deployment with continuous monitoring and model refinement

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

- **Price Optimization Algorithms:** ML models analyzing transactions, competitive data, and behavior for optimal pricing
- **Pricing Segmentation Framework:** Tier-based pricing architecture across account value and purchase behavior
- **Margin Intelligence Dashboard:** Real-time analytics on price realization and margin performance
- **Competitive Pricing Intelligence:** Automated market monitoring and price benchmarking
- **Willingness-to-Pay Models:** Price elasticity analysis by customer segment

Investment: \$250-500K

Timing: 16-20 weeks

Outcomes:

- **Improve margins by 2-5 percentage points** through optimized pricing and value-based segmentation
- **Reduce pricing cycle time by 40-60%** via automated workflows and real-time recommendations
- **Enable data-driven pricing decisions** with market intelligence and AI-powered scenario analysis
- **Achieve competitive differentiation** through dynamic pricing capabilities responding to market conditions
- **Scale pricing operations** with automated processes and continuous optimization

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B TRANSFORMATION: ACCOUNT-BASED SELLING

B2B Commerce

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

B2B organizations face inefficient operations from manual, error-prone order and service processes that increase cost-to-serve and limit scalability. Sales channels are restricted by outdated systems preventing revenue growth across account portfolios. Customers expect D2C-like digital experiences but receive fragmented, non-intuitive buying journeys with no real-time self-service capabilities for ordering, tracking, or account management.

OBJECTIVE

Deploy a comprehensive B2B commerce platform that delivers seamless, data-driven digital buying experiences accelerating growth, lowering costs, and deepening customer relationships. Enable self-service capabilities across the entire customer journey—from product discovery through ordering, fulfillment tracking, and returns. Integrate commerce with ERP, CRM, OMS, and PIM systems to provide real-time pricing, inventory visibility, and personalized experiences that match or exceed D2C standards.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

- Third-Party Marketplace Integration: Expand catalog with 3P sellers using Mirakl or similar platforms for dropship/fulfillment
- Advanced Personalization Engine: AI-driven product recommendations, dynamic content, and account-specific merchandising
- Mobile Commerce App: Native iOS/Android apps for field buyers and on-site purchasing
- B2B Subscription and Recurring Orders: Automated replenishment programs and subscription management
- Order Management System (OMS): Advanced fulfillment orchestration across warehouses, stores, and drop-ship partners

CLIENT

Highline Warren, Andersen Windows & Doors, Lincoln Electric

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

Discovery: Audit existing order processes, customer journey pain points, system architecture, and integration requirements across ERP, CRM, and fulfillment systems

Design: Create B2B-optimized user experiences with personalized catalogs, contract pricing, bulk ordering, account hierarchies, approval workflows, and self-service tools

Build: Implement B2B commerce platform (Adobe Commerce, Salesforce B2B Commerce, commercetools, or similar) with integrations to back-office systems for real-time data

Testing: Validate functionality across user roles (buyers, approvers, admins), product configurations, pricing accuracy, and order workflows with pilot customer groups

Training: Enable both internal teams (sales, customer service, operations) and external customers on portal navigation, ordering, and account management

Rollout: Phased launch starting with priority customer segments, expanding catalog breadth, and iterating based on usage analytics and customer feedback

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

B2B Commerce Accelerators: Pre-built templates and modules for industrial distribution, manufacturing, and retail B2B verticals

Account-Based Experience Framework: Personalization strategies leveraging Merkury identity data for targeted content and offers

Integration Architecture Patterns: Proven approaches for connecting commerce to complex ERP/CRM/OMS/PIM ecosystems

Customer Portal UX Playbook: Best practices for B2B-specific features (approval workflows, punchout, multi-user accounts, quote-to-order)

Digital Adoption Toolkit: Change management and customer onboarding frameworks driving portal adoption and self-service usage

Investment: \$400k - \$1.8m

Timing: 12-28 weeks

Outcomes:

Decrease cost-to-serve by 30-50% across sales and customer service through self-service ordering, account management, and automated processes (call deflection)

Increase customer acquisition rates by 20-35% by removing friction in onboarding and providing modern digital buying experiences that match D2C expectations

Increase average account value by 25-40% through cross-sell recommendations, simplified reordering, guided product discovery, and improved sales velocity

Increase customer retention and satisfaction with 24/7 self-service access, real-time order visibility, personalized experiences, and reduced order errors

Enable scalable growth by digitizing transactions and freeing sales teams to focus on strategic account development versus order processing



YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B TRANSFORMATION: ACCOUNT-BASED SELLING

B2B Marketplace

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

B2B organizations face constrained growth due to limited product catalogs that can't scale without prohibitive inventory costs and storage complexity. Regional fulfillment gaps prevent market expansion while complex seller/vendor onboarding processes cause delays and partner friction. Maintaining quality control and brand standards across a distributed third-party seller network creates operational challenges and customer experience risks.

OBJECTIVE

Launch a comprehensive B2B marketplace that expands sales reach through integrated third-party and dropship seller networks, creating a scalable digital ecosystem that grows product offerings without inventory risk. Enable new category expansion, regional fulfillment optimization, and SKU profitability improvement while maintaining operational efficiency. Deploy marketplace platform (Mirakl or similar) with robust seller onboarding, catalog management, order orchestration, and quality control mechanisms that protect brand standards.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

Advanced Seller Analytics and Performance Management: GMV tracking, commission optimization, seller scorecards, and automated performance enforcement

International Marketplace Expansion: Multi-currency, cross-border fulfillment, and regional seller network development

Marketplace-Specific Merchandising: Category management, search optimization, and promotional tools for 3P seller visibility

Private Label and Exclusive Brand Strategy: Curated seller partnerships for differentiated product offerings

Multi-Marketplace Syndication: Expand presence beyond owned properties to external B2B marketplaces (Amazon Business, etc.).

CLIENT

Airbus, Ulta Beauty

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

Discovery: Develop holistic vision for B2B marketplace including first-party/dropship/3P strategy, category priorities, business case modeling, and competitive positioning analysis

Design: Create comprehensive business processes and operating protocols including seller onboarding workflows, merchandising/category strategies, quality standards, commission structures, and platform architecture

Build: Implement marketplace platform with recommendation engines, seller portal, catalog integration, order routing, payment processing, and back-office system connections

Testing: Pilot marketplace with select seller cohort across priority categories to validate onboarding, fulfillment, and customer experience before broader launch

Training: Enable internal teams (merchandising, operations, customer service) and external sellers on platform usage, policies, performance expectations, and change management

Rollout: Phased seller recruitment and category expansion with ongoing monitoring, optimization, and seller performance management

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

Marketplace Strategy Framework: Business case models, category prioritization, 1P/3P mix optimization, and competitive positioning playbooks

Seller Onboarding Accelerators: Proven workflows for seller vetting, contract negotiation, catalog integration, and performance standards

GMV Optimization Models: Analytics frameworks for marketplace economics including take rates, seller profitability, and category contribution

Quality Control Protocols: Brand protection standards, product content requirements, and automated seller compliance monitoring

Mirakl Implementation Expertise: Deep partnership and certified expertise in leading B2B marketplace platform

Investment: \$750k - \$3m

Timing: 24-40 weeks

Outcomes:

Improve SKU profitability by expanding catalog 200-500% without inventory investment, optimizing product mix between 1P and 3P offerings based on margin contribution

Enable category expansion into new verticals and product lines without capital expenditure, using seller network to test demand before committing inventory

Optimize regional fulfillment by leveraging distributed seller network to reduce shipping costs, improve delivery speed, and expand geographic reach

Achieve seller diversification that reduces dependency on single suppliers, improves negotiating leverage, and creates competitive marketplace dynamics

Accelerate revenue growth with marketplace GMV contributing 15-30% of total B2B revenue within 18-24 months while improving overall margin profile



YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B TRANSFORMATION: ACCOUNT-BASED SELLING

Order Orchestration

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

Orders flow through fragmented systems (EDI, email, fax, phone) requiring manual re-keying across multiple ERPs without unified visibility. Manual exception handling and lack of real-time status create inefficiencies, errors, and poor customer experiences.

OBJECTIVE

Deploy intelligent Order Management System (OMS) as single source of truth with AI-driven automation for structured and unstructured order data. Enable intelligent routing, exception management, and real-time notifications that eliminate manual tracking

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

Fulfillment Optimization: Intelligent routing based on inventory, costs, and delivery commitments

Returns Automation: Streamlined RMA processing and refund workflows

Marketplace Integration: Unified orchestration across 1P, 3P, and supplier fulfillment

Recurring Orders: Automated replenishment and subscription processing

CLIENT

CITGO, Westlake Chemical, Formerra

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

Discovery: Map order-to-cash across channels, identify pain points in capture, routing, and exceptions

Design: Architect unified OMS with automated ingestion, routing rules, and system integrations

Build: Implement OMS with AI-driven processing and real-time inventory visibility

Testing: Validate flows and integrations with pilot volumes

Training: Enable teams on dashboard, workflows, and communication tools

Rollout: Phased implementation with continuous optimization

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

Merkle Unstructured Order Data Solution (Proprietary): AI platform processing orders from emails, PDFs, faxes, and images—eliminating manual entry, reducing errors by 95%, accelerating processing from hours to minutes

Order Orchestration Framework: Best practice architectures for complex fulfillment networks

Exception Management Playbooks: Automated workflows for common B2B order exceptions

Integration Patterns Library: Proven approaches connecting OMS to multiple systems

Investment: \$300k – 800k

Timing: 12-20 weeks

Outcomes:

- **Decrease cost-to-serve by 30-50%** through automation and call deflection
- **Increase order accuracy to 98%+** eliminating manual re-keying
- **Reduce revenue leakage by 15-25%** through exception management
- **Enable seamless omnichannel ordering** with unified tracking
- **Improve fulfillment efficiency by 25-40%** through intelligent routing

PART 4: TRAINING

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B TRANSFORMATION: ACCOUNT-BASED SELLING

Digital Shelf Analytics

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

Brand manufacturers lack visibility into product performance across retailer and marketplace platforms, creating inconsistent customer experiences. Limited competitor intelligence obscures content strategy, pricing positioning, and promotional effectiveness. Retail media spend requires ROI optimization through understanding of promotion cycles and competitive positioning.

OBJECTIVE

Deploy AI-powered digital shelf analytics tracking brand compliance across content quality, pricing, promotions, ratings, search visibility, and availability. Enable data-driven measurement and benchmarking to improve channel performance and optimize retail media spend across retailers, markets, and competitors.

CLIENT

HP, Krue

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

Discovery: Understand brand's e-commerce objectives and retailer relationship priorities

Design: Identify retailer platforms, competitors, and metrics defining winning strategy

Build: Deploy AI-powered analytics collecting data across retailer platforms

Analysis: Analyze trends impacting performance including content gaps, pricing issues, and competitive positioning

Strategy Development: Develop strategies to win digital shelf across markets, retailers, and competitors

Ongoing Optimization: Regular cadence highlighting key changes and strategic impact

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

Digital Shelf Analytics Platform (Proprietary): AI-powered monitoring across 50+ retailer platforms tracking content, pricing, ratings, availability, search position, and promotional compliance

Competitive Benchmarking Framework: Automated share-of-shelf analysis vs. competitors

Retail Media Performance Models: Attribution and ROAS tracking connecting spend to shelf improvements

Content Quality Scorecards: Automated auditing of product content completeness

Always-On Insights Dashboard: Real-time analytics with automated alerting on violations and threats

Investment: \$150-400K

Timing: 12-16 weeks

Outcomes:

- **Gain always-on dashboard** with key KPIs (content score, price compliance, ratings, search rank, availability)
- **Improve product discoverability by 30-50%** through optimized content and competitive analysis
- **Increase sales conversion by 15-25%** by addressing content gaps, pricing issues, and availability problems
- **Optimize retail media spend ROI** with data-driven insights on promotion timing and platform performance
- **Establish regular strategic cadence** highlighting competitive moves and recommended actions

